

ARR-T Modernization: Transforming a Fragmented Compliance Ecosystem into a Unified Analyst Experience

Overview

Role: Lead Product Designer Responsibilities: UX Strategy, Service Design, User Research, Workflow Mapping, Information Architecture, Product Design. Partners: Product Management, BASC Operations, Risk & Controls, Technology, and End Users.

The Challenge

The Analyst Resolution Reporting ecosystem supported approximately 22,000 branch control violations annually. Analysts were required to work across three disconnected applications—ARR-T, MCT, and Branch Dashboard—to investigate violations, communicate with field teams, document remediation efforts, and track resolution progress. Compounding the challenge, ARR-T was a Microsoft Access application identified as a high-risk platform scheduled for decommissioning. The organization needed a modernized solution that reduced operational risk while simplifying analyst workflows.

Discovery & Research

To understand the ecosystem, I conducted stakeholder interviews, user interviews, workflow analysis, UI audits, service blueprinting exercises, and collaborative workshops. The goal was to understand how work moved through the organization, identify inefficiencies, uncover dependencies between systems, and establish a shared understanding of the future-state experience.

Mapping the Existing Experience

Working closely with analysts and business stakeholders, I facilitated workflow mapping sessions that documented end-to-end remediation processes, escalation paths, decision points, and exception handling scenarios. These exercises revealed numerous manual handoffs, duplicated activities, fragmented workflows, and excessive application switching.

Service Blueprinting

To fully understand the operational model, I created service blueprints for ARR-T, MCT, and Branch Dashboard. These blueprints exposed user actions, supporting processes, system interactions, manual activities, and opportunities for automation. The work provided visibility into both front-stage user experiences and the back-stage operational processes supporting them.

Building Alignment

The ecosystem involved multiple stakeholder groups with different responsibilities, goals, and reporting structures. I facilitated collaborative workshops to define user roles, identify core capabilities, prioritize enhancements, establish success measures, and create alignment around a shared modernization strategy.

Vision & Strategy

Research findings informed a future-state vision focused on four strategic objectives: • Retire high-risk Microsoft Access applications • Consolidate ARR-T, MCT, and Branch Dashboard into one experience • Introduce data visibility, reporting, and operational awareness • Simplify research, communication, and remediation workflows The vision emphasized reducing workflow fragmentation while improving operational efficiency and compliance outcomes.

Workflow Modernization

After establishing the vision, I partnered with stakeholders to redesign key workflows and identify opportunities to automate manual processes. Enhancements included automated communications, integrated activity tracking, dynamic filtering, SLA monitoring, personalized work queues, and streamlined escalation workflows.

Balancing Admin & End-User Needs

Research revealed that analysts and administrators had very different needs. Analysts needed faster access to records, improved prioritization, and simpler communication tools. Administrators needed self-service configuration capabilities and greater control over content management. The resulting solution introduced dedicated administrative experiences that reduced reliance on engineering teams for routine updates.

Solution

The final concept unified capabilities from ARR-T, MCT, and Branch Dashboard into a single role-based experience. Key capabilities included: • Personalized work queues • Dynamic filtering and search • Integrated communications • Automated outreach logging • SLA monitoring and prioritization • Administrative content management • Improved visibility into case status and ownership The design reduced context switching and enabled analysts to complete critical tasks within a single application.

Outcomes

- Consolidated three disconnected applications into a unified analyst platform
- Reduced workflow fragmentation and manual coordination
- Increased analyst productivity through automation and prioritization
- Enabled business self-service administration
- Established a modernization strategy supporting retirement of high-risk legacy technology
- Improved visibility into operational performance and case management workflows

Reflection

This project demonstrated that modernization is rarely just a technology challenge. Success required understanding a complex ecosystem of users, systems, processes, and controls while aligning stakeholders around a shared future-state vision. Through service design, workflow engineering, product strategy, and user-centered design, I helped create a foundation for transforming a fragmented compliance ecosystem into a unified operational experience.